

The Hong Kong Polytechnic University

Subject Description Form

Please read the notes at the end of the table carefully before completing the form.

Subject Code	APSS2S12																				
Subject Title	Striving for a Sustainable Livelihood in Greater China																				
Credit Value	3																				
Level	2																				
GUR Requirements Intended to Fulfill	This subject intends to fulfill the following requirement(s) : ☐ Healthy Lifestyle ☐ Freshman Seminar ☐ Languages and Communication Requirement (LCR) ☐ Leadership and Intra-Personal Development ☒ Service-Learning ☐ Cluster-Area Requirement (CAR) ☐ Human Nature, Relations and Development ☐ Community, Organization and Globalization ☐ History, Cultures and World Views ☐ Science, Technology and Environment ☐ China-Study Requirement ☐ Yes or ☐ No ☐ Writing and Reading Requirements ☐ English or ☐ Chinese																				
Pre-requisite / Co-requisite/ Exclusion	NIL																				
Assessment Methods	<table border="1" style="width: 100%; border-collapse: collapse;"> <thead> <tr> <th style="width: 40%;">100% Continuous Assessment</th><th style="width: 30%;">Individuals Assessment</th><th style="width: 30%;">Group Assessment</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>1. Performance in community service-learning project</td><td style="text-align: center;">30%</td><td></td></tr> <tr> <td>2. Final report for community service</td><td></td><td style="text-align: center;">20%</td></tr> <tr> <td>3. Reflective Journals</td><td style="text-align: center;">30%</td><td style="text-align: center;">--</td></tr> <tr> <td>4. Seminar presentation</td><td style="text-align: center;">--</td><td style="text-align: center;">20%</td></tr> <tr> <td>5. Service Learning E-learning Module</td><td style="text-align: center;">Pass/Fail</td><td style="text-align: center;">-</td></tr> </tbody> </table> - The grade is calculated according to the percentage assigned; - The completion and submission of all component assignments are required for passing the subject; and - Student must pass all the components (acquire more than half of the percentage assigned) if he/she is to pass the subject.			100% Continuous Assessment	Individuals Assessment	Group Assessment	1. Performance in community service-learning project	30%		2. Final report for community service		20%	3. Reflective Journals	30%	--	4. Seminar presentation	--	20%	5. Service Learning E-learning Module	Pass/Fail	-
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Objectives	The objectives of the subject are to: 1. enhance students' understanding on the basic conditions for sustainable livelihood and their relation with the socio-economic structure; 2. facilitate students' empathetic understanding on the life of the peasants/villagers in rural village and workers in urban/rural area in Greater China region; 3. foster students' cross-cultural interpersonal communication skills through community services; 4. motivate students to become an active life-long learner and responsible civic citizen through building close relationships with serving community members; 5. help students to reflect the value of their knowledge learnt in the University in building a sustainable livelihood for the poor and disadvantaged.
Intended Learning Outcomes <i>(Note 1)</i>	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: a. Demonstrate a deeper understanding on the issues and struggle of sustainable livelihood and the factors contributing to sustainability/ unsustainability of the livelihood of the local people in Greater China; b. Communicate and work with the local people effectively in different social and political system; c. Apply the knowledge and skills they have acquired to deal with complex issues in the service setting; d. Demonstrate empathy for people in need and a strong sense of civic responsibility; e. Formulate modes of assistance for helping marginalized people with diversities for empowering them; f. Demonstrate an understanding of the linkage between service-learning and the academic content of the subject; g. Reflect on their role, choice, life goal and responsibilities both as a professional in their chosen discipline and as a responsible citizen.
Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus <i>(Note 2)</i>	The subject is designed to encourage students to embrace knowledge and practices through community service and social learning from partnership with community organizations serving various disadvantaged groups in Greater China. 1. Service-Learning and University Education 2. Issues of sustainable development in Greater China and all over the world: situations, reasons and trends 3. Unsustainable vs sustainable livelihood for rural population in Greater China 4. Poverty alleviation and development practices: different efforts by local and international NGOs 5. Program planning for service-learning and skills in delivering service-learning 6. Moral and ethical considerations for the community/social development practitioner and the relationship with services recipients 7. Critical reflections • Experiencing marginalization and crisis in fast developing rural areas • Visions of equality and social justice: value clarification

	Professional training and social responsibility: contribution to the sustainable livelihood for the disadvantaged																									
Teaching/Learning Methodology (Note 3)	This subject aims to enable students to learn more about sustainable livelihood issues through community service-learning. Before students are assigned to their community service-learning project, they are expected to attend a series of lectures aiming at providing them with an understanding of development issues in Greater China. They will also be given opportunities to meet representatives from the partnering community organizations to find out in greater details the work and community services they are expected to perform before they are fully engaged in their service-learning project. Furthermore, reflective seminars will be organized so that students can share with their seminar members on cases related to unsustainability/sustainability experiences in different places. The three broad aspects in service-learning, i.e., attitude change, skills enhancement and knowledge consolidation, will be emphasized throughout the service-learning experience. Before the service trip, the students will have to fulfil 12 hours of lecture and complete 10 hours of Service Learning e-learning module “Learn to Serve, Serve to Learn: Introduction to Service-Learning” delivered by the Service Learning and Leadership Office at PolyU. It consists of readings, exercises and assessments that are designed to introduce students to the basic concept and practice of service learning. <u>Students are required to successfully complete the e-learning module in order to pass the subject.</u> Two three-hours seminars will be held for students to share case studies of sustainable livelihood. Another 12 hours will be spent on preparing for the community services, conducting activities such as: - Home visits for needs assessment of peasants/villagers - Support the activities organized by community residents’ group - Offer community services for the disadvantaged population in the community - Consumers’ opinion survey on services/trading provided by social enterprises - Web/pamphlet design for social enterprises - Minor improvement works in the Village - Impact/evaluative study for NGO During the service learning period, the students will visit a rural village in Greater China region including Guangdong, Taiwan and Hong Kong for eight to ten days at the summer semester/semester break to deliver services. Service plans will be developed by the partner NGOs with the local community. Expense for the trip will be shared by the student.																									
Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes (Note 4)	<table><tr><th rowspan="2">Specific assessment methods/tasks</th><th rowspan="2">% weighting</th><th colspan="7">Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)</th></tr><tr><th>a</th><th>b</th><th>c</th><th>d</th><th>e</th><th>f</th><th>g</th></tr><tr><td>1. Performance in community service-learning project (team work, awareness/</td><td>30%</td><td></td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td></td></tr></table>	Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)							a	b	c	d	e	f	g	1. Performance in community service-learning project (team work, awareness/	30%		✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	
Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting			Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)																						
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1. Performance in community service-learning project (team work, awareness/	30%		✓	✓	✓	✓	✓																			

	attitude change, skills and knowledge consolidation)								
	2. Final report for community service (appreciation of the experience and possible contribution of his/her professional knowledge)	20%	✓	✓	✓		✓	✓	✓
	3. Reflective journals (appreciation of relationships between diversities and inequality, understanding of civic responsibility and social justice)	30%	✓		✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	4. Seminar presentation (communicating progress and commitment to service-learning)	20%	✓	✓		✓	✓	✓	✓
	5. Service Learning E-learning Module	Pass/Fail		✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	
	Total	100%							

Explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes:

Students are expected to engage in 8-10 days of community service-learning. They will be monitored on their teamwork performance and community involvement. In assessing this, their skills in planning, implementing activities, communication and problems solving, as well as their commitments in service-learning will be carefully considered on the basis of their performance assessed by supervisors from the community service organization and feedback from service recipients.

In addition, students are required to submit two pieces of reflective journals at different times throughout the service-learning subject to indicate how they understand their service-learning experience, particularly in terms of their critical appreciation of the relations between sustainability, diversities and social inequality, as well as their understanding of civic responsibility and social justice.

For the final report, students in small groups are expected to articulate what they have learnt throughout the lectures, seminars, service process and re-examine the basic questions raised in the subject: the values of rural livelihood and rural village, and in what ways to enhance the sustainability of rural sustainable life through their professions and their own personal effort.

Other than written work, students will participate in two seminars to explore the unsustainable cases and sustainable attempts in different places . Feedback and discussion from seminar members will then be sought, and these will serve as supplementary information for assessment.

Student Study Effort Expected	Class contact:	
	Lectures, service learning e-learning module, preparatory workshops, and reflective seminars	40Hrs.
	Other student study effort:	
	Community Service in Greater China 8-10 days in summer semester/semester break	65Hrs.
	Preparation for reflective reports	20Hrs.
	Self-directed study	20Hrs.
	Total student study effort	145 Hrs.
Medium of Instruction	English	
Medium of Assessment	English	
Reading List and References	Halberg, Niels & Muller, Adrian. (2013). <i>Organic Agriculture for Sustainable Livelihoods</i>. Oxon: Routledge. Healy, G., Kirton, G. and Noon, M. (Eds.) (2011). <i>Equality, inequalities and diversity: Contemporary challenges and strategies</i>. Basingstoke: Palgrave Macmillan. Morse, Stephen & McNamara Nora (2013). <i>Sustainable Livelihood Approach: a critique of theory and practice</i>. London: Springer. Oxfam. (2004). <i>Not Utopian: Theories and Practices in Community Economy</i>. Hong Kong: Oxfam. (in Chinese) Slavick, Madeleine Marie. (Ed) (2007). <i>The Possible – 30 Stories</i>. Hong Kong: Oxfam. Yeung, Sik Chung (1999). Poverty Eradication and Social Work. In Ho, K.W & Yuen Tsang, W.K. (ed). <i>Approaching New Century: the new trend of social work theories and practices</i>. Hong Kong: Bafun Books Yeung Sik Chung (2011). “Rethinking Rural-urban Co-operation, Fair Trade, Ecologism and Sustainable Livelihood” in Zhang, Heqing, et al. (ed) <i>Social Work in Disaster: Practice and Critically Review in China Mainland</i>. Beijing: Social Science Literature Press. (in Chinese) Zhang, Heqing (ed) (2013) <i>Rural Social Work</i>. Beijing: Higher Education Press. (in Chinese) Yunus, M., & Jolis, A. (1999). <i>Banker to the poor: Micro-lending and the battle against world poverty</i>. New York: Public Affairs. 213-236	
Notes to student	- This is a 2-semester subject to be conducted in Semester one-two or Semester Two and Summer Term. - This subject requires students to travel to rural Guangzhou/Taiwan/Hong Kong in semester break/summer term for around 8-10 days to conduct field visits.	

	3) Students are required to pay HKD\$2000 for Taiwan Service Trip or HKD\$1000 for Guangzhou Service Trip. 4) Students are expected to deliver services in Putonghua and Cantonese effectively, hence elementary level of Putonghua and Cantonese are expected before enrolling the subject. 5) Sharing offered by the collaborating organization are conducted in Chinese.
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Note 1: Intended Learning Outcomes

Intended learning outcomes should state what students should be able to do or attain upon completion of the subject. Subject outcomes are expected to contribute to the attainment of the overall programme outcomes.

Note 2: Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus

The syllabus should adequately address the intended learning outcomes. At the same time over-crowding of the syllabus should be avoided.

Note 3: Teaching/Learning Methodology

This section should include a brief description of the teaching and learning methods to be employed to facilitate learning, and a justification of how the methods are aligned with the intended learning outcomes of the subject.

Note 4: Assessment Method

This section should include the assessment method(s) to be used and its relative weighting, and indicate which of the subject intended learning outcomes that each method purports to assess. It should also provide a brief explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes.